



Deserts Are Dry



It is a well-known fact that deserts are dry. But why? A desert is a large area of dry land where there is very little or no rainfall. Deserts are arid. Arid means dry.

Deserts Are Dry

Deserts are known to cover about 20 percent of the Earth's land surface. Deserts can have sand dunes, mountains, bare rocks and gravel. Some deserts have no sand at all.

Deserts Are Dry

Some of Earth's greatest deserts are the Sahara and Namib Deserts in Africa, the Gobi Desert in Asia and the Atacama Desert in South America.

Deserts Are Dry

Deserts can be very hot, and get very cold at nighttime. The Sahara is the hottest desert in the world. Cold deserts are the Gobi and the Antarctic Polar in Antarctica.

Deserts Are Dry

Despite being very dry, deserts are home to some plants and animals. These living beings have adapted to live in a harsh, dry environment.

Deserts Are Dry



Deserts Are Dry



Plants like cacti and yuccas are common in deserts. They have special roots that help them absorb any water that is available. Desert animals include camels, snakes, lizards and small rodents.

Deserts Are Dry

Life is hard in the desert but it is possible. The largest desert cities are in Cairo in Egypt and Lima in Peru. Some of the world's greatest civilizations have made their mark on history in the deserts, even though they are so dry.

Deserts Are Dry